-=REDSHIFT=-

ELITE A.G.R.L.

Rules & Regulations

Welcome to the A.G.R.L.

Intro

The Anti-Gravity Racing League is a professional organisation, composed of skilled pilots, engineers, race mechanics, track officials, other staff. Inclusion into their ranks as a pilot means you are one of the most skilled racers on the planet.

Races may be held as one-off exhibition events, or form part of a championship circuit or even the grand prix. It's all up to you as to how you choose to compete.

Tracks

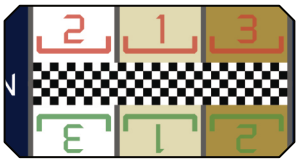
All races happen on a track, whether that be a short sprint circuit, a grand arena race, or even a start-to-finish rally track. Almost all tracks in the league can be raced in both directions, creating different styles of race even on the same track.

All tracks have an official length, and contain various special symbols, such as Agility ratings on corners, Boost Pads for extra speed, and Powerups to enhance ships that pass over them. Some tracks also feature death-defying jumps, or semi-legal shortcuts to get ahead of faster opponents.

For your first few races we recommend starting with the smaller, faster tracks. These give an excellent introductory experience, with a race length of about 45 minutes, allowing you to get a few races in. The Cairo Circuit is intended as the ideal introductory track, combining short straits and simple turns, without jumps, shortcuts, or obstacles.

The Cairo Circuit is shown in the setup instructions on page 4.

Later you can graduate to the bigger tracks, or include endurance racing rules, or even run a Championship Series of multiple races.



Start/Finish Line

All tracks include a Start/Finish line, marked with a large chequered area. This is not treated as a space for movement, just as an extra thick line dividing two spaces. Your ship has passed the start/finish line when it is at least 1 space over the line, in the race direction.



Race Direction

This determines which way around the track your ship must move. In addition, it also determines which way corners are run (for entering and exiting corners), and which Boost Pads are active for this race.

While the general direction of all the ships may be useful, on complex, twisting, or overlapping tracks a race direction marker () can be used as a reminder of which way is supposed to be forwards.

Changing race directions changes the feel of each track, and requires a slightly different strategy when managing dice and overheat levels.

Ending & Winning Races

A race ends at the end of the round when at least one ship has crossed the finish line the required number of times—twice, in a 2-lap race, for example.

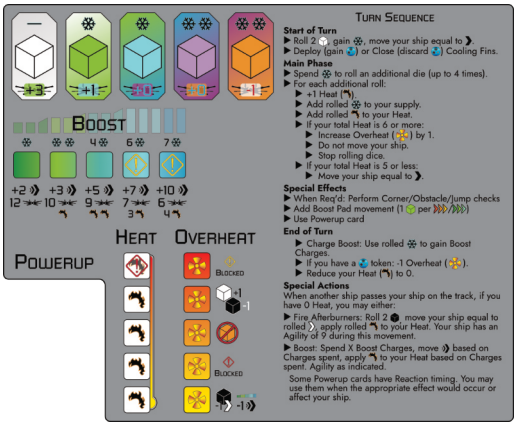
The winner of the race is the ship that is furthest past the finish line and has completed the required number of laps. Corners, shortcuts, and jumps are ignored when a ship has passed the finish line and ended the race. Ships cannot use Boost, Afterburners, or Powerups when they have finished the race (are over the finish line with the required number of laps).

Ships

All racers require a ship, and it is the ship that determines how well you can race. Many marques and models are available, but for the lowest and highest grade races the differences are so minor that they may be treated as the same ship for all intents and purposes.

A ship is represented by a small board kept in front of you. You will place your Thrust Dice, and other counters on or near this board, tracking your ship's Heat, Overheat, available Boost, and current Powerup.

For your first few races, we recommend using the generic ship boards. After that, you are free to mix and match your favourite ship manufacturers into the race, each of which has 2 marques of ship available to use.



The generic ship dashboard is shown to the left, with slots to track your current Heat and Overheat levels, and your current Boost charge.

There is also a quick reference guide for the turn sequence, along with the costs and Agility rating for the standard dice.

Heat/Overheat Tracks

The Heat and Overheat tracks on the boards are separate, and each you roll or that your ship suffers must be applied to the Heat track.

If your Heat track is at the top, then any further will cause your ship to suffer 1 Overheat ().

At each level of Overheat, negative modifiers are applied to your ship. You must apply the modifier for the current level on the Overheat track, and each modifier below that.

For example, a ship with 3 Overheat would suffer -1 movement from Afterburners and Boost, would suffer an additional Overheat at 5+ Heat instead of 6, and would be unable to roll orange dice () for movement.

Boost Charges

As you gain Boost Charges, move your marker right along the Boost track. When you apply Boost, you move the indicated distance () with the stated Agility rating (), then apply the indicated Heat () to your ship. After moving and applying Heat, move your marker 1 space left on the Boost track for each Charge you used (the marker can be moved off the track, representing 0 Charges remaining).

Game Setup

Track Setup

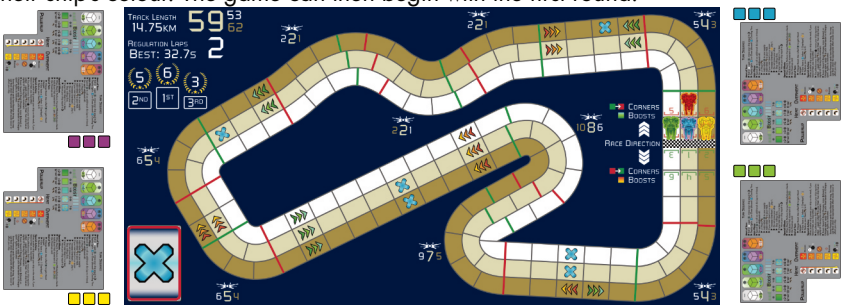
Select one of the available tracks and lay it out in the centre of the play area. You will need a little bit of extra space around it for playerboards and rolling your dice. Choose the race direction, showing the relevant side of the direction token ().

Shuffle all the Powerup cards and place them on the indicated space.

Player Setup

To determine the first player, take the player order tokens, shuffle them around, then each player draws one at random and places their ship on that spot on the Starting Grid matching the race direction colour.

Every player then takes a playerboard, an Action token (), and 3 marker cubes matching their ship's colour. The game can then begin with the first round.

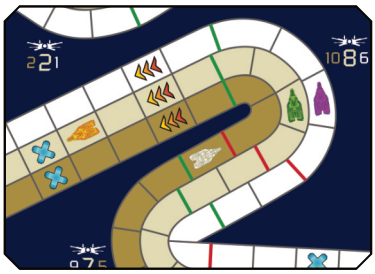


In the example above, the table has been set for 4 players. Ships are placed in position on the Starting Grid, the Powerup cards have been shuffled and placed in their spot, and each player has placed their playerboard next to the track.

Determine Active Player

At the start of the game, the first Active Player is determined by the starting position of each ship (the red or green number in its grid space). The player with the highest number goes first.

During the game, the Active player is determined by checking the position of each ship on the track. The player with the ship that is furthest behind, and that still has an Action token, becomes the Active Player. If ships are in the same relative space, the ship in the outside lane is further behind than the centre lane, and the ship in the centre lane is further behind than the inside lane.



In the example to the left, the Active Player would be White (furthest behind), followed by Green (equal with Purple, but on the centre lane), Purple (equal with Green, but on the inside lane), and finally Orange (furthest ahead).

Note that while the centre lane space is technically slightly ahead of the inner lane space, they still share almost their entire border, and so can be treated as being in the same relative position.

Turn Sequence

Emergency Procedures

At the start of your turn you may choose one option:

- **Close Cooling Fins:** Discard a Cooling token if you have one.
- **Open Cooling Fins:** Take a Cooling token if you don't have any.
- **Deploy Repair Drones:** Suffer 1 Heat and discard your Powerup card to remove 1 token. Maximum dice for Increase Thrust is limited to 3.
- Do nothing.

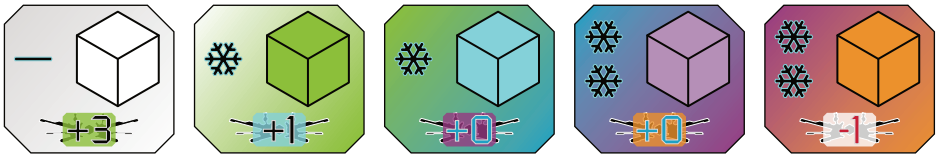
Basic Thrust

After performing Emergency Procedures, perform the following steps, in order:

- Roll 2 white dice. Move your ship the number of spaces rolled.
- Gain Coolant equal to the symbols displayed on the dice you rolled.
- Set your Agility to 6 (3 for each you just rolled).

Increase Thrust

You may spend Coolant to roll up to 4 additional dice (up to 3 additional dice if you used Deploy Repair Drones), with costs as shown in the image below. Each additional dis rolled separately, in sequence.



For each additional die you roll, regardless of its colour:

- Your ship suffers 1 Heat, plus any rolled Heat.
- Add any rolled Coolant to your supply.
- Modify your ship's Agility based on the colour of the die.

If your total Heat is 6 or more (5 or more with 3+ Overheats):

- Increase your ship's Overheat by 1.
- Do not move your ship for this roll.
- Stop rolling dice. Go to Reset & Recharge.

If your total Heat is 5 or less:

- Move your ship the number of spaces rolled (-1 if you have any).
- If you have rolled 3 or less dice to Increase Thrust, you may choose to spend additional Coolant to roll 1 additional die.

Reset & Recharge

After performing Basic Thrust and Increase Thrust, perform the following steps:

- Reduce your ship's Heat to 0. Recover all spent Coolant.
- If you have a Cooling token, reduce your ship's Overheat by 1.
- If you rolled more Coolant than Heat this turn, you may **Charge Boost**.
  - Pay Coolant to move your marker right along the Boost track. You may gain multiple Charges if you have sufficient Coolant to pay for each Charge.
- Flip your Action token face down.

Example Turn | Tokens

Token Effects

Drag token ( ): Each time you roll a die during the Increase Thrust step on your turn, Fire Afterburners, or use Boost, your ship moves 1 less space (, , or), and then you discard one of these tokens.

Swerve token ( ): Your ship's Agility ( ) is reduced by the number of tokens on it. Each time your ship exits a corner you may discard one of these tokens.

During the Reset & Recharge step of your turn, you may spend Coolant ( ) 1-for-1 to remove and/or tokens. You may do this in addition to buying Boost Charges.

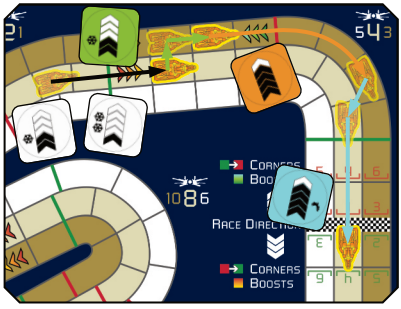
Moving Your Ship

When moving your ship, each rolled or gained , , or allows you to move your ship 1 space forward on the track, following the current race direction. You must always move as far as possible for each die roll or effect.

Important: The first space you move each round must be directly forwards.

When moving you may have to avoid Obstacles, pass other ships (or Slipstream behind them), change lanes, follow corners, jump, or attempt shortcuts. Each of these is covered on the following pages, but all are treated as part of movement.

Example Turn



In the example to the left, the orange ship has performed its movement for the round.

It started with 3 spaces and 3 Coolant ( ) from its basic thrust (2), shown with the black arrow.

That player then decided to roll an additional green die ( ) by paying 1 Coolant, suffering 1 Heat ( ), getting 2 more spaces (green arrow) and 1 more coolant.

With 3 Coolant available, the orange ship decides to punch it, suffering 1 Heat and rolling an orange die ( ). It gains 4 spaces (orange arrow) and no extra heat. Its current Agility of 6 is more than enough safely clear the corner.

With 1 Coolant remaining, the orange ship decides to roll a blue die ( ), paying the remaining Coolant, suffering 1 Heat, plus 1 additional Heat rolled on the die, and gaining another 4 spaces of movement (blue arrows).

The orange ship moved over 1 Boost Pad and 1 Powerup. The player gains a Powerup card as they did not currently have one (they could have replaced an existing card). For the Boost Pad, the player elects to use Safe Mode, having no Boost Charges to spend, and rolls 3 spaces on that die (not shown).

The orange ship's player could then gain 2 Boost Charges by spending a total of 3 Coolant (1 for the first charge, 2 for the second). Their turn is then over.

Round End

After all players have moved their ships and used any bonus effects, the round ends, all players flip their face down Action tokens ( ) face up ( ), and unless the race is finished, a new round begins.

Corners

Your ship is considered to be in a corner if it is between the closest starting and ending line of the indicated colour for the current race direction.

If your ship's current Agility ( ) is equal to or greater than the rating for that corner, it may move normally. This does not subtract any Agility—it merely checks if you have enough in total.

Swerve: If your ship's Agility is less than the rating for that corner, and you have no tokens, your ship is moved 1 lane toward the outside of the corner (this movement is in addition to your ship's normal movement), or suffers 1 token for each missing point of Agility.

tokens suffered from this result do not apply to your ship until it either exits the corner or your turn ends.

If your ship cannot be moved further out for any reason (such as already being in the outside lane), it must suffer tokens.

Spin out: If your ship's Agility is less than the rating for that corner, and you have one or more tokens, it is reset to one space behind the starting line of that corner, any additional movement from that die is lost, and if it is your turn you must stop rolling dice, and go to the Reset & Recharge step of your turn.

Important: If your ship is inside a corner, or within 1 space of a corner, at the start of your turn, when you roll dice for Basic Thrust you do not need to move immediately if your Agility is too low for that corner. Instead, you may roll additional dice (Increase Thrust) before moving in order to increase your Agility.

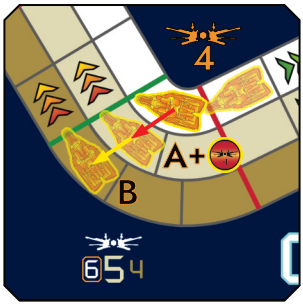
If you use this option, each additional die you roll before moving must be a white die ( ).



In the example to the left, the orange ship is taking a corner, moving in the red direction, while carrying a token (-1 Agility).

While it is in a space between the closest red and green lines (red outlines on ship) it is considered to be in that corner, and must maintain the required Agility (5 in this case, for the center lane).

If its Agility was reduced to 4 by some effect (such as being hit with a weapon), it would be returned to the space behind the start of that corner (blue outline on ship), and its turn would end.



In the example to the left, the orange ship is taking the same corner, but its Agility (4) is too low to safely take the corner on the inside lane (Agility 6).

The ship currently has no tokens, so its player could choose to either move it 1 lane out (position A), and suffer a token, or 2 lanes out (position B), and suffer no tokens.

Lanes | Obstacles | Ramming

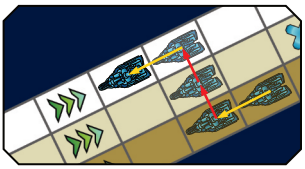
Lanes

You may change lanes with your ship at any point during its movement.

When a ship changes lanes it costs 1 space of movement (❯, ❯❯, or ❯❯) to move sideways. You may change lanes with your ship multiple times during your turn, provided you have sufficient movement to do so.

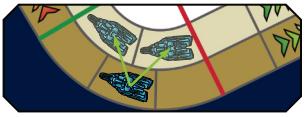
Important: You can only change lanes once when performing movement with Afterburners or Overboost.

If your ship's space is adjacent to multiple different spaces in the target lane, you may choose which of those spaces your ship moves in to.



In the example to the left, the blue ship changes lanes during the middle of its move, spending 2 spaces to move across 2 lanes (red arrows).

It then continues its movement using any remaining spaces (yellow arrow).



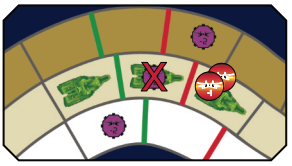
In the example to the left, the blue ship changes lanes while adjacent to multiple spaces. It can move to either of the available space when changing lanes (green arrows).

Obstacles & Ramming

If your ship enters the same space as an Obstacle it has hit that Obstacle. Any additional movement from your current die is lost. Note that other ships also count as Obstacles, but will instead count as being Rammed.

Your ship suffers 2 tokens for each Obstacle it hits.

If your ship starts its movement in the same space as an Obstacle (at any point on your turn), it may ignore that Obstacle—it has obviously already done its damage.



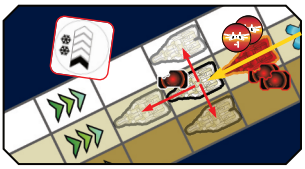
In the example to the left, the green ship hits an Obstacle, in this case a Mine token 'helpfully' laid by another ship.

The green ship hits the Obstacle, removing the token, but it suffers 2 tokens. At least the track is now clear for future laps, or other ships.

Ramming

If your ship Rammed another ship, roll a die. You may move the Rammed ship 1 space (including sideways and backwards) for each rolled (❯). You cannot move a Rammed ship into another ship, but it can be moved into other Obstacles.

Your ship suffers 1 for each rolled. The ship you Rammed also suffers 1 .



In the example to the left, the red ship Rams the white ship. The red ship's movement ends, and its player rolls a die. The white ship is then moved 1 space by the red player to any legal space (red arrows). The white ship suffers 1 damage ( ), while the red ship is unlucky and suffers 2 damage (1 per rolled), along with the 2 tokens for hitting an Obstacle.

Jumps | Slipstream

Jumps

If your ship enters the same space as the Jump symbol ( ) it must attempt to Jump to the next closest jump symbol. This is always shown with a Speed value, representing the number of spaces the jump counts as for movement purposes.

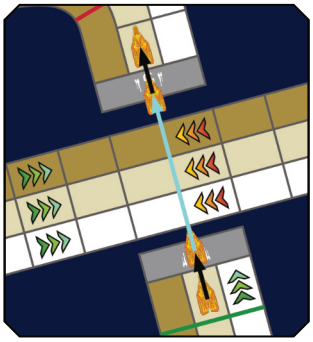
In order to clear a Jump, your ship must spend spaces (, , or) equal to the number on the Jump symbol ( ). Your ship is then placed on the next closest jump symbol. If your ship has any tokens, you may discard 1 of them.

Important: If it is your turn, then before moving or continuing to move your ship, you may roll additional dice (Increase Thrust) before moving, adding them together until you have enough movement to clear the Jump before you start moving your ship.

If you use this option, each additional die you roll before moving must be the fastest die you can afford, either or (or if is not possible).

If your ship cannot roll enough spaces to clear the Jump, you lose any remaining movement, your ship stops on the Jump space, and if it is your turn you must stop rolling dice and go to the Reset & Recharge step of your turn.

Important: A ship on a Jump space is not an Obstacle, and may be freely Passed by any other ships moving into or through that space.



In the example to the left, the orange ship encounters a Jump as it moves. If it had 5 or more space of movement to spend, it would be placed on the next Jump symbol (blue arrow), and would then continue its turn.

If the ship failed the Jump, it would be placed on first Jump space, and its turn would end.

Note that as the Jump is 3 lanes wide, it can be entered from any lane, and counts as only a single space. For the same reason, leaving the matching Jump space on the far side, a ship may move in to any lane (so this Jump allows ships to also change lanes for free).

Slipstream

If your ship is 1 or 2 spaces directly behind (in the same lane as) another player's ship at the end of your turn, you may Slipstream if your ship has no tokens.

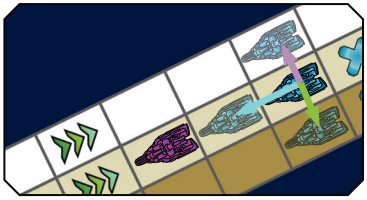
When you Slipstream with your ship, you may choose one of the following options:

- Change Lanes
- Hot Pursuit

Change Lanes: Change lanes once, following the normal rules.

Hot Pursuit: Move forward 1 space, and discard 1 token from your ship.

Note that Slipstream movement cannot be used to Ram another ship.



In the example to the left, the blue ship ends its move 2 spaces behind the purple ship, and is thus allowed to Slipstream.

It can choose to either change lanes (purple and green arrows) or move 1 space forward (blue arrow), both of which are free.

Reactions

Reactions/Passing other ships

Two ships cannot occupy the same space on the track (except Jump spaces), in order to pass another ship, you must physically move around it.

Important: During the first round, ships may move through spaces occupied by other ships, but still cannot end their movement in the same space.

You have Passed another ship when your ship is at least one full space ahead of that ship. This is the point at which that player may perform a Reaction—a special movement or response to being passed.

When your ship is Passed, you perform one of the following Reactions:

- Fire Afterburners
- Overboost
- Use a Powerup
- Do Nothing

Fire Afterburners: If your ship currently has no Heat (), you may roll 2 black dice (). Move your ship the number of spaces () rolled, and add any rolled Heat () to your ship. During this movement your ship has an Agility () of 9.

When performing this movement you can only change lanes once, and you gain no bonuses from Boost Pads.

Overboost: Spend all of your Boost Charges. Move your ship the number of spaces () indicated for the number of Charges spent, and add any indicated Heat () to your ship.

When performing this movement you can only change lanes once, and you gain no bonuses from Boost Pads.

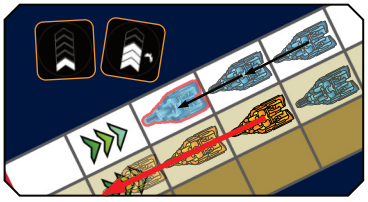
Note that the movement from Overboost is performed at a set Agility () rating. Your ship uses the indicated Agility rating until the Overboost move is complete, then reverts to its normal rating.

Use a Powerup: Use the Reaction effect of your current Powerup card. Any restrictions or requirements will be printed on that card.

Do Nothing: Bide your time, either because you've already used a Reaction earlier in the round, or you want to save an effect for a critical moment.

Important: You have the opportunity to perform a Reaction each time your ship is Passed during a round. While in most cases you can only perform one Reaction per round due to Heat buildup, there are some effects that may be used multiple times.

In addition, you cannot 'hold' a Reaction for the next time that ship acts. You must use it immediately when your ship is passed, or you count as doing nothing.



In the example to the left, the blue ship Passes the orange ship by moving around it in the inside lane (black arrows). The blue ship is not considered to have Passed the orange ship until it enters the space where it has a red outline.

The orange ship can respond with a Reaction, in this case it chooses to Fire Afterburners, moving 4 spaces (red arrow) and suffering 1 Heat ().

Boost Pads | Shortcuts

Boost Pads

Each time your ship moves over a Boost Pad (/) of the colour matching the current race direction, then after resolving any remaining movement and effects from the current die, you may choose one of the following options:

- Safe Mode
- Overboost

Safe Mode: Roll 1 , and move your ship the number of spaces () indicated. Ignore all other symbols (,) on that die. In addition, if your ship has any tokens, you may discard 1 of them.

Note that the from a Boost Pad does not alter your ship's Agility in any way, and does not count against the limit of dice you can roll during your turn.

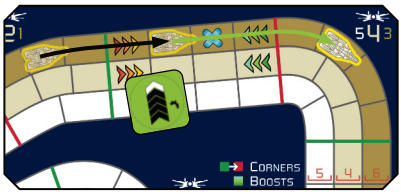
Overboost: Spend all of your Boost Charges. Move your ship the number of spaces () indicated for the number of Charges spent, and add any indicated Heat () to your ship.

When performing this movement you can only change lanes once.

Note that the movement from Overboost is performed at a set Agility () rating. Your ship uses the indicated Agility rating until the Overboost move is complete, then reverts to its normal rating.

Important: Boost Pads in the opposite race direction colour are ignored completely (ie: when racing in the red direction, green Boost Pads are ignored).

Important: When moving your ship as part of a Reaction, you do not gain any bonus from Boost Pads.



In the example to the left, the white ship has finished moving (black arrow). During this movement it passed over a Boost Pad.

The player chooses to use Safe Mode, and so rolls an extra . They are lucky to roll a massive 4 spaces, taking the ship over a Powerup space, and well into the corner. The rolled from the die is ignored.

Shortcuts

Many tracks have special routes that allow a ship to bypass Obstacles or reduce distance traveled. These are known as Shortcuts, and some can be risky, requiring greater skill to navigate than the main track.

In order to use a Shortcut, your ship must be able to change lanes at least once.

Shortcuts have both a Speed and an Agility rating (combining effects of a Jump and a Corner). Your ship must be able to meet both requirements. If it fails either requirement, it is returned to the regular track one space after the Shortcut entrance, and you must go to the Reset & Recharge step of your turn (but your ship does not suffer any tokens).

Powerups

Each time your ship moves over a Powerup space (), you may draw a Powerup card.

Your ship may only have one Powerup at a time. You may choose to discard an existing Powerup to a draw a new one if desired.



Using the example on the previous page, by passing over the Powerup space, the white ship draws a Powerup card, in this case, a Turbo. It may use this card during any future round. If it passes over another Powerup space during a future round, it may choose to either keep this card, or to discard it and draw a new one.

Range: All Powerup cards have a range for when they are used. Some will specify a number of spaces—count these as you would for movement. Other cards have a range of Ship, meaning they affect only your ship.

Uses/Duration: All Powerup cards have a set number of Uses. When no uses remain, the card is discarded after resolving its effect. If a Powerup card also has a Duration, it is not discarded until that Duration has expired, even if it has 0 Uses remaining.

Note that you may still choose to discard a partly used Powerup card in order to draw a new one, if desired.

All Powerup cards also have a timing for when they are used, which is one of the following:

- Action
- Action (turn)
- Reaction
- Action/Reaction
- Instant

Action: You may use the effect after resolving the movement from any die roll on your turn. This also means that if you are forced into the Reset & Recharge step of your turn, you lose the option to use the effects.

Action (turn): You must use this effect at the start of your turn, before rolling any dice (but after the Emergency Procedures step). This replaces your normal turn actions (Basic Thrust, Increase Thrust) with the stated effect.

Reaction: You may use this effect any time you would be allowed to perform a Reaction.

Action/Reaction: You may use this effect as if it had the Action or Reaction timing. The card will state if the effect changes in some way between the timing options.

Instant: You may use this effect at any time, on any player's turn, including your own. This effect interrupts and takes priority over all other effects.

For example, if your ship would Overheat due to Heat generated from dice, you could use the instant effect of a Powerup card that reduces your Heat in order to stop that Overheat.

Overheat | Damage | Repairs

Discarding Dice

If a Powerup or other effect forces a die to be discarded, all rolled results (Cooling, Heat, and spaces of movement) are ignored. If a die had already been used, and was lost as part of an interrupt, the target ship is essentially reset to the state and track position it was in before resolving any effects from that die.

The only exception to this full reset mechanic is that the Heat suffered to roll an extra die remains on the ship.

Overheat Effects

There is a quick reference on the player board for these effects, but the full effects are explained here for clarity.

- **1** — Your ship loses 1 space of movement (», or ») when using Afterburners or Overboost.
- **2** — Your ship Overheats when you have 5 or more total Heat, instead of 6.
- **3** — You cannot roll orange dice during the Increase Thrust step of your turn.
- **4** — During Basic Thrust you roll 1 additional white die. When using Afterburners you roll 1 less black die.
- **5** — Your ship is limited to a maximum of 3 Boost Charges.
- **6+** — Your ship is eliminated.

Deliberate Overheats

If your ship has 5 Heat, you may still choose to roll an additional die. You will lose the movement, but any Coolant rolled remains, so this can be an option in a tight spot to get some extra Boost Charge, or clear off some more / tokens.

The Pit Lane

If your ship moves into the Pit Lane (marked with green-white spaces), you may immediately reduce your Overheats and Damage to 0. You may also discard all / tokens on your ship.

When your ship enters the Pit Lane, it can only move a maximum of 2 spaces per die rolled while it remains there. In addition, you cannot spend Coolant to buy Boost Charges while your ship is in the Pit Lane.

Repair Drones

At the start of your turn, if your ship has any Damage on it, you may increase your Heat by 1, and discard your Powerup card in order to remove 1 from your ship. Doing this counts as rolling a die for Increase Thrust, so you will be limited to 3 additional dice this turn.

Player Elimination

If your ship ever has a combined total of 6 or more Overheats and Damage, it is eliminated from the race, crashing in its current space. Your ship then becomes an indestructible Obstacle (it may be Rammed or moved by other effects, but cannot be removed from the track).

Note that while possible, unless you've really been pushing your luck (and/or Ramming a lot of things), actual elimination is quite rare.

Championship Series

Championship Races

Decide on the number of races that championship series requires. A short series should be 3-4 races, all on different tracks. A long series (or grand prix) should involve at least 6 races, and will probably take a dedicated evening.

If you intended to run more races in a grand prix than there are available tracks, simply use the reverse directions on tracks you have already used.

Championship Points

When running a Championship Series, there is a points ladder to be worked out when the race is over. The 3 ships furthest past the finish line at the end of race gain the indicated number of championship points for that track.

Each other ship that finishes the race (crossed the finish line at the end of the race) earns 2 championship points.

Any ships still on the track, but not past the finish line, earn 1 championship point.

Keep a note of these points for the next games.

All ships are reset to no heat, no damage, and any eliminated ships are fully repaired.

Fast Play Options

When there are 6 or more ships on the track, 2 players at a time can perform their turns simultaneously, as shown in the table below.

Players	Active Turns	
6	3	6
7	3	7
8	4	8

If it is unclear how to resolve the timing of any effects when two players are active, the player that started furthest behind resolves their effects first.

Overheat | Damage